

Ragnarok, Arthur, and the Green Return

The Clokey Story, the Fall of the Old World, and What Grows Now

There are two myths that tell the same story.

In Norse mythology, Ragnarok is not the end of the world. It is the end of a world – one that had become so corrupted that even the gods couldn't save it. The great tree Yggdrasil, which held everything together, was poisoned at its roots. The serpent gnawed from below. The gates of Asgard were guarded by beings who had betrayed their purpose. And when it all finally burned, something happened that the old powers never expected. The earth came back green.

In Arthurian legend, a good king builds a kingdom on a principle – the Round Table, where no seat is higher than another. The kingdom is beautiful. It works. And then it is destroyed from within – not by an outside enemy but by betrayal at the heart of the court. Camelot falls. Arthur is carried to Avalon. But the legend doesn't end with the fall. It ends with a promise: *Rex quondam, rexque futurus*. The once and future king. Arthur returns.

Both myths say the same thing: the good world will be corrupted. The corruption will come from within. The old order will fall. And something green will grow from what was lost.

This is the story of my family. This is the story of Gumby. And this is why I'm building what I'm building.

My name is Sage Clokey. I am the third Arthur.

The Creator - The First Arthur

My grandfather, Art Clokey, made a small green figure out of clay in 1955. He called him Gumby.

Most people remember Gumby as a toy, a cartoon, a piece of nostalgia. But my grandfather was a seminary student, a Buddhist, a man who followed Sai Baba and called his studio Premavision. He didn't make Gumby to sell merchandise. He refused to license Gumby for eight years after creating him. He said: "I was a very idealistic person, and I didn't want to exploit children."

He called Gumby "an act of love to children."

Gumby was green - the color of life, of growth. His shape was a seedling: legs like roots, arms like branches, head leaning toward the sun. He was made of clay - a material that doesn't command. It becomes. It transforms. And Gumby entered his stories by walking into the pages of books. Imagination was the doorway, not a product.

My grandfather trained more than half the animators who worked on Tim Burton's *Nightmare Before Christmas*. His people went to Pixar. They went to Disney. Art stayed independent. He ran his own studio in Sausalito. He never sold. He never surrendered control. He never let anyone else decide what Gumby meant.

In the Arthurian cycle, there is a figure called the Green Knight. He appears in *Sir Gawain and the Green Knight* - the oldest and strangest of the Arthurian stories. He is not a villain. He is a test. He rides into Camelot uninvited, green from head to foot, and challenges the knights of

the Round Table to prove their integrity. He is nature itself, walking into the court and asking: *Are you worthy of what you claim to be?*

My grandfather was the Green Knight of children's entertainment. He walked into the industry with something pure - a green figure made of clay, an act of love - and his very existence was a test. Are you here for the children, or are you here for yourself? Are you building something true, or are you running a machine?

The industry failed the test.

He was the first Arthur. He built his Camelot - small, independent, principled. A round table of one.

The Corruption - Mordred at the Gate

In the Arthurian legend, Camelot doesn't fall to an invader. It falls to Mordred - the traitor within. The one who was supposed to be part of the court but was working against it the whole time. The corruption is internal. The betrayal comes from inside the walls.

While my grandfather was making clay move with love, something was growing inside the entertainment industry. Something at the roots.

In the 1980s, a man named Jeffrey Epstein began building a network. He compromised powerful people - finance, politics, media, science - and used that leverage to place loyal operators in gatekeeper positions across American institutions. This is not speculation. It is documented in court records, flight logs, contact books, and the testimony of survivors.

By the early 1990s, the people who controlled what American children could watch were connected to this network:

Geraldine Laybourne ran Nickelodeon from 1984 to 1996 - commanding 57% of all children's television viewership. More than ABC, CBS, NBC, and Fox combined. She appears in Epstein's black book. Her husband Kit,

who worked at Nickelodeon, MTV, and the Children's Television Workshop – the organization behind Sesame Street – also appears. They both sat on the board of KinderCare, one of the largest childcare chains in America.

In 1994, Laybourne hired Dan Schneider at Nickelodeon. He was given unsupervised access to child actors for 25 years. He was exposed in 2024 for abusive and predatory behavior. The woman who gave him that access is in the records of a convicted child trafficker.

Rupert Murdoch controlled Fox, Fox Kids, News Corp, and later much of the distribution pipeline. He appears in Epstein's black book.

Sumner Redstone controlled Viacom – the corporate structure above Nickelodeon, MTV, Paramount, CBS, and Blockbuster. He faced multiple lawsuits alleging sexual exploitation.

These were not peripheral figures. These were the people who decided what stories American children were allowed to hear. They sat at the table. They wore the armor. And they served the serpent.

The world calls them pedophiles. The word comes from Greek – *paidos* (child) + *philos* (love). Child lovers. But that is a lie built into language. What they did was not love. The accurate word is pedophagy – *paidos* (child) + *phagein* (to devour). Child devourers. They didn't love children. They consumed them. They fed on innocence, on trust, on vulnerability. They fed on the access that children's media uniquely provides – the trust parents place in the people making their children's shows.

My grandfather called Gumby "an act of love to children." *That* is what love looks like. Protection. Creation. Giving freely without taking. The people at the gate did the opposite. They took. They consumed. They devoured. And they called it entertainment.

The corruption of language is part of the corruption of the system. Calling predation "love." Calling monopoly "deregulation." Calling gatekeeping "curation." The serpent always wears the skin of the thing it's killing.

At the same time, the government was building the wall that made them inescapable. The FCC had claimed ownership of the broadcast spectrum since 1927. No one could legally reach an audience without a government-issued license. And in 1996, the Telecommunications Act – sold as deregulation – removed the caps on how many licenses one company could hold while keeping the license system intact. Fifty media companies became six. Six companies controlled three-quarters of everything America saw and heard.

In the Norse telling: the tree was poisoned. The serpent was at the root. The gates were held by people who had no right to hold them.

In the Arthurian telling: Mordred sat at the Round Table and smiled while the kingdom rotted from within.

Same story. Same betrayal. Same result.

The Lockout - The Sword Denied

In the Arthurian legend, there is a sword in a stone. Only the rightful heir can pull it free. Everyone else tries and fails – not because they're weak, but because the sword isn't theirs. It recognizes its king.

But what happens when the stone is surrounded by guards who won't let the rightful heir near it?

My grandfather finished the Gumby movie in 1992. No major distributor would touch it for three years. Not Paramount. Not Fox. Not Disney. Not Warner Bros. It was finally released in 1995 through a tiny company called Arrow Releasing, in 21 theaters. It grossed \$57,000.

But it sold a million copies on VHS.

A million families bought it when they could find it. The audience was there. The demand was proven. The only thing missing was access – and access was controlled by people in Epstein's black book.

This wasn't a market failure. In a free market, a product with a million buyers finds distribution. This was a system where a government-created monopoly was captured by a blackmail network, and an independent creator who refused to exploit children was starved out because he couldn't be controlled.

The sword was in the stone. The people recognized it. But the guards around the stone worked for Mordred.

Gumby went dark. The old world closed its gates.

The Fisher King

There is a figure in the Arthurian legends older and stranger than Arthur himself: the Fisher King.

The Fisher King is a wounded ruler whose injury will not heal. And because the king is wounded, the land itself becomes a wasteland. The crops fail. The rivers dry up. The kingdom decays - not because of war or invasion, but because something is broken at the center. The wound is the cause. The wasteland is the symptom.

The only cure is the Grail - and the only way to find the Grail is to ask the right question. In the oldest versions of the story, a young knight enters the Grail Castle, sees the wounded king, sees the Grail procession pass before him - and says nothing. He doesn't ask the question. And because he doesn't ask, the king remains wounded and the wasteland endures.

The question is: *Whom does the Grail serve?*

Not "who owns it." Not "who controls it." *Whom does it serve?*

My grandfather died on January 8, 2010, at 88 years old. He left Gumby to his son - my father, Joe Clokey. The second Arthur.

My father became the Fisher King.

He carried a wound he may not have fully understood – the wound of an industry that had locked his father out, a system that smiled at him across the table while blocking every path forward. He spent eight years fighting to bring Gumby back. He went to Disney. The deal fell through. He signed a six-year joint venture with Classic Media – they were supposed to produce a new movie and a new series. They produced nothing. The license expired. He partnered with the Jim Henson Company for a new stop-motion series faithful to my grandfather's vision. No co-production partner would fund it. The project died in silence. He went to Amazon. The deal fell through. He launched a comic series. Cancelled after three issues.

The pattern was always the same. Interest expressed. Agreements reached. Then killed from above, for no apparent reason.

My father was trying to bring Gumby back through the front door of a building whose owners had decided he would never enter. He didn't know why the doors kept closing. He just kept knocking. He was the Fisher King – wounded by a system he couldn't see, trying to heal a wasteland he didn't create, carrying something sacred through a kingdom that had been hollowed out from within.

But he saw more than I understood at the time.

A few months before he died, my father told me he was "being affected by them the same way Jim Henson was."

I was fourteen. I didn't fully understand what he meant.

Jim Henson – creator of the Muppets, another independent children's creator operating outside the corporate system – died on May 16, 1990, at 53 years old. Sudden infection. Organ failure. Dead within 48 hours of being admitted to the hospital. He had been negotiating to sell the Muppets to Disney. The deal collapsed after his death. It took fourteen years for Disney to finally acquire them.

My father saw the parallel. He named it. He identified a “them.” He connected his own experience to Henson’s – two independent creators of beloved children’s properties, both blocked by the same system, both dying suddenly in their fifties.

Months after saying those words, on February 2, 2018, my father collapsed. Brain bleed. One month later, on March 2, he was dead. He was 56 years old. Henson was 53.

Sixteen months later, Jeffrey Epstein was arrested.

The Fisher King fell. He had seen the wound clearly enough to name it. And no one asked the question in time.

The Fall - Ragnarok and Camelot

My father’s death was the end of the old fight. The Clokeys had held the line for sixty-three years – from 1955 to 2018. Three generations. Independent. Uncompromised. Unbroken.

But both kingdoms were falling.

In 2018, the same year my father died, the platforms that independent voices used to reach audiences were systematically destroyed. Facebook purged 800 pages of independent media. Alex Jones was deplatformed simultaneously by every major platform. The algorithm was rewritten to crush independent reach. They called it content moderation. The Mises Institute called it the Great Social Media Purge.

In 2019, Epstein was arrested. In August, he was found dead in his cell. Both cameras malfunctioned. Both guards were asleep.

In 2020, Steve Bing – a movie producer who had talked to the FBI about Epstein – fell from the 27th floor.

In 2022, Jean-Luc Brunel – the modeling agent who trafficked girls to Epstein and was awaiting trial – was found hanged in his Paris prison cell.

The same year, February 2022: Fox Entertainment bought Gumby. All of it. Film, television, streaming, merchandise, licensing, publishing. Everything my grandfather built. Everything my father died protecting.

Fox is controlled by Rupert Murdoch. Rupert Murdoch appears in Jeffrey Epstein's black book.

They are now making *Gumby Kids* – 2D animation, not claymation. Written by someone from Disney's Mickey Mouse shorts. No clay. No stop-motion. No philosophy of transformation. No act of love to children. The green seedling flattened into a corporate product.

Gumby was the last major American children's character still held by its creator's family as a small, independent operation. Thomas the Tank Engine went to Mattel. Peanuts went to Sony. Peppa Pig went to Hasbro. VeggieTales was bought at a bankruptcy auction. When Fox took Gumby, the consolidation was complete. Every beloved character that American children grew up with is now inside the corporate stack – owned by the same system that was connected to the network that abused children.

In the Norse telling: that's Ragnarok. The old world burning. The gods who tried to protect it, fallen. The serpent swallowing the tree.

In the Arthurian telling: that's the fall of Camelot. The Round Table broken. The knights scattered or dead. Mordred on the throne. And Arthur carried across the water to Avalon – not dead, but gone. Waiting.

Rex quondam, rexque futurus. The once and future king.

The Green Return – Avalon and the New Earth

Both myths end the same way.

In Ragnarok, after the fire, after the flood, after the old powers destroy each other – the earth comes back. Green. Clean. New. Two figures step out of the wreckage to begin again.

In the Arthurian legend, Arthur doesn't die. He is carried to Avalon – the island of apples, the place where things heal, where the old magic still lives. And the promise is carved on his tomb: *Here lies Arthur, the once and future king*. He will return when the world needs him.

The third Arthur is not a repetition. He is the return.

I am not trying to bring Gumby back. That fight belonged to my father, and the old world took it from him. I am not trying to rebuild Camelot. Camelot fell because it was built inside a system that could be corrupted. I am building something that cannot be corrupted in the same way – because it doesn't depend on the same system.

I'm a bioinformatics student at UC Santa Cruz. I've built a genome design system that retrieves genes from over two hundred organisms and assembles them into novel biological sequences. The north star is living architecture – structures that grow, self-repair, and adapt. Not built from dead materials. Grown from living ones.

My grandfather showed the world what freedom looks like through clay and story. I'm showing what freedom looks like through biology – that life organizes itself without central control, and we can design with that principle instead of against it.

The project is called The Living Age.

It is open-source. It is on GitHub. There is no deal to collapse. No license to expire. No single person whose death transfers the IP to the cartel. No FCC license required. No gatekeeper's permission needed.

The old world needed their gates because the old world ran on scarcity – scarce broadcast spectrum, scarce shelf space, scarce distribution channels, all controlled by government permit. The new world runs on

abundance – open protocols, open code, open biology. You can't gatekeep what anyone can fork.

My grandfather needed NBC's permission to reach an audience. My father needed Disney's, Amazon's, Fox's. I don't need anyone's permission. The internet is the first distribution system in history that doesn't require a government license. And biology is the first building material that grows itself.

In Arthurian terms: the first Arthur pulled the sword from the stone – but the stone was surrounded by Mordred's guards. The second Arthur received Excalibur from the Lady of the Lake – but the lake had been poisoned. The third Arthur doesn't need a sword given by the old powers. He is growing one from living wood.

The Round Table and Voluntary Order

There is one more thing the Arthurian legend gets right.

The Round Table was not just a piece of furniture. It was a design principle. No seat at the head. No throne above the others. Every knight equal. The table's shape made hierarchy impossible. It was a physical encoding of an idea: that order can exist without domination.

That idea has a name. In political philosophy, it's called voluntarism – the principle that all human association should be voluntary. No coercion. No central authority deciding who sits where. Order that emerges from free cooperation, not from command.

In biology, it has another name: self-organization. Living systems – from cell colonies to ecosystems to the human body – organize without central control. No cell is king. No gene is dictator. The order emerges from local interactions, feedback loops, and shared signals. Life has been running on voluntary order for four billion years.

The Round Table was the right idea in the wrong material. It was built of wood, inside a castle, defended by swords. It could be broken. It was broken.

The Living Age is the Round Table rebuilt in a material that can't be broken the same way - open-source code, biological systems, distributed networks. Not because the idea was wrong. The idea was always right. The implementation needed to evolve.

My grandfather's Gumby walked through books - entering stories as an equal participant, not a conqueror. Voluntary exploration. No hierarchy. Clay that becomes rather than commands.

The Round Table. Voluntary order. Self-organization. Gumby walking into the pages.

It's all the same principle. It always was.

Three Arthurs, Three Materials, One Message

Arthur I - Art Clokey - Clay

Shaped clay into a living metaphor for freedom. Clay transforms. It becomes. It doesn't command. He showed children that the world is not rigid - it can be shaped by imagination, by love, by walking into the pages of a book and becoming part of the story.

He built his Camelot. He kept it independent. He refused to kneel.

Arthur II - Joe Clokey - The Wound

Tried to carry the vision through a world that had been captured. He knocked on every door. Every door closed. He was the Fisher King - carrying something sacred through a wasteland, wounded by a system he couldn't see. He died fighting for something he believed in, 16 months before the world learned how deep the corruption went.

He held the Grail. He couldn't find anyone worthy to share it with.

Arthur III - Sage Clokey - Living Code

Building with living organisms. DNA that assembles itself. Structures that grow without blueprints. Systems that don't need central control because life has been solving that problem for four billion years.

Not pulling the sword from the stone. Growing one from the root.

Clay to code. Story to system. Gumby to genome. Camelot to the Living Age.

The medium changed. The message didn't.

What the Myths Teach

The Norse and the Britons told the same story because they understood the same truth: good systems get corrupted, and the corruption comes from within.

Yggdrasil was poisoned by the serpent at its root. Camelot was destroyed by Mordred at the table. The American media system was captured by a blackmail network sitting in the gatekeeper's chair. The mechanism is always the same: the people trusted to protect the thing become the ones who devour it.

But both myths also teach that the fall is not the end. Ragnarok produces the green earth. Arthur returns from Avalon. The Fisher King's wound is healed when someone finally asks the right question.

The right question was never "How do we get back inside the old system?" That was my father's question, and the old system killed him for asking it.

The right question is the Grail question: *Whom does it serve?*

The old media system served the gatekeepers. The FCC served the license holders. The cartel served itself. The blackmail network served the serpent.

The Living Age serves life. Living architecture serves the people who inhabit it. Open-source code serves anyone who reads it. Voluntary order serves everyone at the table equally.

Whom does the Grail serve?

Everyone. That's the answer. That's always been the answer. And that's why the old system couldn't allow it – because a Grail that serves everyone makes the gatekeeper unnecessary.

Seeds and Swords

My grandfather said Gumby was an act of love to children. He meant it. He refused to exploit them. He refused to sell out. He stayed independent for fifty-seven years, and his son held the line for eight more, and the system killed them both – one slowly, through starvation of distribution; one quickly, at 56, one month from onset to death.

I am not going to ask permission from the people who did that.

I am going to build something they can't touch. Something that doesn't depend on their licenses, their platforms, their distribution, their funding. Something that grows on its own because that's what living things do.

Art made a green seedling out of clay and showed children that the world transforms through imagination.

I am building living architecture – literally growing structures from biological code – and showing the world that freedom is not a political theory. It is a design principle. It is how nature has organized itself for four billion years. Voluntary order. No central control. No permission required.

The old tree fell. The serpent won for a while. Camelot burned. The Fisher King bled out. Mordred sat on the throne and called it progress.

But the green comes back. Arthur returns. The Grail finds its bearer.

Not through the old gates. Not with the old sword. Not in the old medium.

In the open. In code. In living things.

Rex quondam, rexque futurus.

Stories are seeds. This one has been in the ground for seventy years. It's time for it to reach the light.

The Living Age Book II: The Mythology of Media